Consequently, 1946 was a watershed year for Maharaja Hari Singh. His state was a composition of five parts: the Gilgit region, Ladakh, Poonch, the Kashmir Valley and Jammu. Each of them was ethnically, religiously and linguistically different from each other. In three of these parts, the Maharaja's personal agendas had empowered three formidable men whose actions, in 1947, were not only going to dismember the state from the consolidated whole that it was in 1946, but would also dispossess him from his rule, and force him into exile. These men, destined to play key roles in the breaking up of the state and the unseating of the Maharaja, were Sheikh Abdullah in the valley, Sardar Muhammad Ibrahim Khan in Poonch and Capt. William Brown in the Gilgit Agency. The tragedy is that apart from Sheikh Abdullah, the Maharaja was completely unaware of the potential upheavals the actions of Sardar Muhammad Ibrahim Khan and Capt. William Brown could cause.

The Maharaja's mind was so occupied with pursuing his own agendas that he had no clue of the trouble brewing right behind his back. He also had no way to foretell the impact that the departure of the British would have on his state. The Maharaja had forgotten that he was able to amass all this power only because the British had swung their weight in his favour, in the battle for succession to Maharaja Pratap Singh's throne. He forgot that it was only because of his father, Raja Amar Singh's continued demonstrative loyalty towards the British that he got his throne. The Maharaja forgot that his predecessor, Maharaja Pratap Singh, paid a very heavy price for trying to establish his independence from British control.

If the Maharaja had thought through his moves in advance and chosen to study the works of the great Indian political scientist, Chanakya and followed his directives, he would never have pursued his personal vendetta against Raja Jagat Dev Singh of Poonch. He would have handled the British with finesse rather than imperiousness. He would have never permitted xenophobia to get out of hand and prevented the British from establishing a constitution. Chanakya's *Arthashastra* lays down the virtues of an intelligence network that informs kings and rulers not only about the plans